

May/June 2008 solutions with analysis

question1

This was a straightforward question requiring candidates to define communism as a form of economic and political system in which the means of production and exchange are commonly owned and equally distributed. Some good candidates gave good definition and were awarded full marks.

However, some candidates failed to score good marks in their answers because they could not distinguish between communism and socialism. Hence, they were writing on the features of socialism instead of communism. The overall candidates' performance in the question was below average. Some of the salient points some weak candidates left out in their answers included:

- it is classless society.
- opposition not tolerated.
- economy is collectively planned.
- state withers away, etc.

question2

This was a popular and straightforward question. Majority of the good candidates that attempted this question scored very good marks. Those who were able to expatiate their points were also handsomely rewarded.

However, some of the weak candidates that attempted the question were confused. They interpreted rule of law as Fundamental Human Rights. Instead of defining rule of law as the principle and procedures necessary for the protection of individual from arbitrary government, many of them did otherwise and to extensively on Human Rights. This shortcoming dwindled the overall performance in the question to average.

Most candidates who scored high marks in the question did not fail to identify some of the following ways of ensuring Rule of Law:

1: entrenchment of Rights in the constitution.

2: Independent judiciary.

- Democratic political system
- Literate population, to know their rights.
- Trial must be open, etc.

question3

The question was popular as it was attempted by majority of the candidates.

The good candidates were able to identify the ways in which the rights of citizens can be protected, and they explained them. These candidates scored high marks.

Some candidates listed the Fundamental Human Rights of citizens only instead of stating the ways by which the rights can be protected. This resulted to heavy loss of marks, reducing the overall performance in the question to average. Some of the points expected from the candidates included:

- reduction in poverty level in the society.
- establishments of public complaints commission.
- entrenchment of Rights in the Constitution.
- freedom of press is essential, etc.

question4.

This was another popular question that was attempted by majority of the candidates. The good candidates defined public opinion as the general opinion that the majority of people in a country hold on a given public issue at a particular time; they were handsomely rewarded. They were also able to identify the factors that promote public opinion in a state as demanded by the Ob' part of the question.

However, the major obstacles to candidates' high performance in this question was their failure to expatiate some of the points they identified. The overall candidates' performance in the question was well above average. Some of the factors candidates listed in their answers included:

- the use of the mass media should be free.
- encouraging the use of opinion polls on issues.
- responsible and responsive social institution.
- existence of political parties will help to mould the opinion of the people, etc.

question5.

Although, this was a familiar and popular question, the candidates wrote the functions of local governments without presenting their points as importance. Candidates who fell victim of this lost substantial marks.

However, some good candidates scored high marks in the question because they understood the demands of the question and presented their answers logically. The overall candidates' performance in the question was a bit above average.

In order to score good marks in this question, candidates were expected to state some of the following points.

- local government helps in educating people at the grassroots.
- helps to preserve the traditional institutions of the people.
- allays the fear of insecurity and ethnic domination.
- creates jobs opportunities.
- serves as link between the people and the central/state government, etc

question6

This question was very popular among the candidates. Majority of the candidates that attempted the question performed very well in it. They gave correct answers, and they developed the points appropriately.

Some of the points listed by the good candidates included:

- They took part in the colonial government policy of indirect rule.
- They presided over native courts.
- Helped in tax assessment and collection.

- The took Part in law making.
- Preserved the culture and customs of the communities, etc.

question7

This was very unpopular question with the candidates as only very few of them attempted it. The few that attempted it wrote out of point. Many candidates did not understand the demands of the question and subsequently gave sketchy analysis.

The definition given by majority of the candidates was poor and failed to define Crown Colony as a form of direct rule of British annexed territories in which the British established political institutions which were used in ruling the people who were regarded as British subjects.

Moreover, the very few candidates who managed to provide few points in the 'b' part of the question also failed to expatiate them. The overall performance of candidates in the question was poor. Candidates scored low marks in this question because they failed to identify some of the following points:

- The legislative councils were dominated by the British in the 1920s.
- The Governors were virtually colonial dictators as they had veto powers.

- Educated elite were excluded from the administration of the crown colony.
- The Governors had casting vote, etc.

question8

This question was a popular one as it attracted majority of the candidates. The candidates were able to define nationalist movement as an association formed by a group of people who share common interest to resist political domination, economic exploitation, racial discrimination and cultural intimidation and to struggle for political independence.

Moreover, many candidates were able to give a good account of the effects of Nationalism as demanded by the 'b' part such as:

- increased African participation in politics.
- Introduction and extension of franchise in West Africa.
- struggled to Africanise the civil service.
- development of political parties.
- achieved independence to their respective countries etc.

The overall candidates' performance in the question was very good.

question9.

The question was straightforward and popular. Most candidates answered the two parts correctly and they scored good marks. There was no identifiable difficulty in the candidates' response to the question. The overall candidates' performance in the question was well above average.

Candidates did not forget some of the following merits of Littleton constitution:

- it introduced true federalism.
- it removed the Governor General and the lieutenant Governors from membership of the Legislative Councils.
- it regionalized the civil service and the judiciary.
- it reduced official representatives in the Legislative Council, etc.

Also, the following demerits were identified:

- failed to create the office of the Prime Minister at the centre.
- failed to provide for second chamber at the federal level and Eastern region.
- Nigerian Supreme court had no power to entertain appellate cases, etc.

question10

This was a popular question that attracted majority of the candidates. However, most candidates that answered the question misunderstood the intention of the question, they misfired by explaining factors for military intervention in politics instead of reluctance in relinquishing power to civilian administration. This affected candidates' performance. Their overall performance was below average. Better still, the few good candidates who knew the requirement of the question stated some of the following reasons:

- Desire to ensure that they totally eliminate the political party they unlawfully overthrew.
- Some of the soldiers begin to feel that they are better administrators than their civilian counterparts.
- The support from civilians who benefit from military administration.
- Disunity among civilian politicians, etc